Dynatrace · Quick concepts

Interview revision sheet. Read it the evening before, then test yourself in Interview practice.

Core components

- OneAgent: one agent per host, auto-instruments processes and services.
- ActiveGate: routes traffic, monitors cloud APIs, hosts private synthetic locations.
- Davis AI: detects problems and finds root cause using topology.
- Smartscape: live dependency map of hosts, processes, services and apps.
- PurePath: end-to-end distributed trace down to code level.

Entities and data

- Host, process group, service, application. Host groups set at install time.
- Grail stores data; query with DQL (fetch logs, then filter, then summarize).
- Request attributes capture values such as order IDs for analysis.
- Calculated service metrics build custom metrics from request data.

Problems and alerting

- A problem groups related events with impact and root cause.
- Automatic baselining plus optional static thresholds.
- Management zones split data by team; auto-tags drive zones and filters.
- Alerting profiles decide which problems notify and when.
- Problem notifications and Workflows connect to ServiceNow, Slack, Jira and PagerDuty.
- Maintenance windows suppress alerts during planned work.

User experience

- RUM: user sessions, user actions, Apdex (0 to 1 satisfaction score).
- Key user actions for business-critical steps; Session Replay.
- Synthetic monitors: browser clickpaths and HTTP monitors.

Operations

- Dynatrace Operator deploys OneAgent and ActiveGate on Kubernetes.
- Restart processes after installing OneAgent so they are instrumented.
- Custom service detection and extensions cover what is not automatic.
- Send deployment events from CI/CD so Davis can link problems to releases.
- Site Reliability Guardian checks SLOs as release quality gates.
- SaaS (hosted by Dynatrace) vs Managed (runs in your environment).